NL · GROWW · GROWTH TEAM

In my interviews, first SIPs were at risk when a red number met someone else's opinion, not when a debit failed.

Goal: more first-time mutual fund investors with an active SIP 12 months after they start. No fund picks, no fear, and cancelling stays easy.

526

first-time investors among the **1,917 public posts** the engine read

5 of 5

interviewees were at risk because they **decided to stop**. None because a debit failed.

15–17 / 20

real investor messages where the AI cancel sheet understood the worry (3 runs). **Fixed rules alone: 8.**

AI Discovery Engine ↗
Streamlit, open to anyone

Live MVP ↗
"Before You Cancel" sheet

AI Evidence Log ↗
sources, golden set, fixes

User research ↗
screener, guide, P1–P5 notes

BUSINESS METRIC DECOMPOSITION

A first SIP is lost in one of two ways: a debit fails, or the investor decides to stop. I went after the decision.

North star: % of first-time mutual fund investors with at least one successful instalment in the last 30 days, 12 months after their first SIP.

1 · The SIP goes live

KYC (identity check), autopay set-up and the first debit all work

10%

of first-timer stop posts

Fixable by operations, not product

2 · Every debit goes through

Low balance, old salary account, nobody told them

18%

of first-timer stop posts

Fixable by operations, not product

3 · They keep choosing to continue

Decides to stop or switch after red or flat months	**19%**
A pause or cash squeeze becomes a cancel	**10%**
Can't read the returns screen, drifts off	**9%**

MVP focus

Orange = fixable by operations (payments, bank and support processes), not by a new product screen. **Blue** = where I built.

What the definition tells us: a smaller amount still counts as active, and a skipped month only hurts if it lands in the 30-day window. So at the cancel button, **reduce or skip is a save**. A lapsed SIP also comes back with one successful debit inside 30 days.

NL · Groww % = share of 68 first-timer posts about a SIP ending. The other 34% gave no clear cause.

One pipeline turns 4,546 scattered posts into a sized, checkable map of why first SIPs end

1 · Collect
4,546
posts: Play Store, App Store, Reddit, YouTube, TradingQ&A

›

2 · Filter
2,209
about their own SIP, duplicates removed

›

3 · Tag (LLM)
1,917
stage, months in, SIP status, trigger, quote

›

4 · Cause (rules)
1 each
visible cause per stop post, mapped to a branch

›

5 · Size & ask
526
first-timers; uplift per area; Q&A cites post IDs

HOW I CHECKED THE AI

- 20 hard posts I labelled by hand. The LLM matched me **86%** on "instalment failed" (keywords: 57%).
- **1,886 of 1,917** AI-picked quotes appear word for word in the post.

WHERE I OVERRULED IT

- Its "why they stop" label matched me only **33%**, so causes come from visible rules instead.
- Q&A answered "Which fund should I buy?", so I added a guard: **58 of 58** test questions handled.

Try the engine ↗
Ask a question, or read the posts behind every number

Posts came out a tie between failed payments and stop decisions, and a market fall didn't separate quitters from stayers

68 FIRST-TIMER POSTS ABOUT A SIP ENDING

Main cause in the post	Posts	Share	Reach	Gain
Failed payments	**19**	**27.9%**		**+2.9**
First SIP never went live	7	10.3%	0.8	0.99
A later debit failed	12	17.6%	0.9	1.90
Stop decisions	**20**	**29.4%**		**+2.3**
Stopped after red or flat months	7	10.3%	0.5	0.62
Stopped to switch fund or app	6	8.8%	0.7	0.74
Cash squeeze	4	5.9%	0.6	0.42
Pause or skip didn't work as expected	3	4.4%	0.9	0.48

Gain (percentage points on the 12-month rate) = 40% of first SIPs gone by month 12 × share × reach × 30% can come back. E.g. 40 × 17.6% × 0.9 × 30% = 1.90. **Reach** is my estimate of how much of a cause a fix can touch. Without it: +3.4 and +3.5.

Too close to call. So I took both into interviews, with the rule written first: whichever 3 of 5 people describe wins.

WHAT CHANGED MY THINKING

1. **The fall is the trigger, not the reason.** People who kept going mention falls as often as people who stopped.
2. **Payment posts are about not being told.** Across all 121 payment stop posts (all investors): 32 failed with no reason, 20 debited with no units, 13 never went live.
3. **"Panic" was the wrong word.** Of 9 stops in a fall I labelled, 4 were fear.

PRIMARY RESEARCH · 9 SCREENED, 5 INTERVIEWED

In all 5 interviews the SIP was at risk because of a decision to stop. Nobody stopped over a failed debit.

4 of 5
judged the SIP only by red or green, against a return they hoped for in a year

4 of 5
knew only two options: keep going or stop

3 of 5
still invest, just not in SIPs: fixed deposit (FD), recurring deposit (RD), lump sum, gold

	Month	Where they are now	Who settled the doubt
P1	12	Running, nearly moved to RD	Office colleague: "just hold on"
P2	14	Stopped, money in FD / RD	Finance YouTubers
P3	8	Planning to stop	Nobody. "Everything seems very vast"
P4	11	Stopped, lump sums instead	Cousin, after a tax-saving fund (ELSS) lock-in surprise
P5	15	Halved, half to a gold scheme	A friend, and a jeweller's offer

> *"Whenever I see my money in red, i feel like stopping the SIP and put the money in RD" · P1*

> *"I stopped my sip and left my investment money as it is because i was not sure what to do" · P2*

TARGET SEGMENT · ROOT CAUSE · PROBLEM

The problem: first-timers can't tell what's normal for their SIP, so when it looks red they ask someone else

1 · WHAT IS THE TRUE PROBLEM?

It isn't mainly panic, cash or payments. The app shows returns, never "is this normal for my fund at month 12, against my goal?". So they ask someone else, often whoever got them started, and do what that person says.

2 · WHO IS IT FOR?

The Red-Number Doubter · 22–32, salaried, ₹1k–10k a month, started on someone's word, 8–15 months in. **Target**

The Quiet Mover · moving new money to FD / RD / gold (3 of 5). Same moment, same sheet.

The Payment Casualty · debit failed, never meant to stop. **Excluded: fixable by operations**

3 · WHY SOLVE THIS NOW?

Tapping Cancel SIP is the one moment we know they're deciding, and today the app only asks "are you sure?". Reduce, skip and change date already exist, but 4 of 5 didn't know.

4 · VALUE IF WE SOLVE IT

Users: decide on their own numbers, and stopping is still a fine choice. **Groww:** a reduced or skipped SIP still counts as active, and the money stays invested.

Problem statement: In their first year, first-time investors judge their SIP only by red or green against a one-year expectation. With no way to tell what's normal, they ask someone they trust, then stop, reduce or move the money out of SIPs.

SOLUTION RATIONALE

Explain their own SIP and offer smaller moves at the cancel button: never a nudge, a fund pick or a scare

A · "x% kept going"

Show how many in this fund continued

+ Cheap to build

– Only 1 of 5 cared. Fit 1 of 9 posts. Reads like an endorsement.

B · Fall alerts

Push a note when markets drop

+ Reaches people early

– Adds worry at the worst time, to people who didn't ask.

C · "You'll lose out"

Warn what stopping costs

+ Might cut cancels

– Fear. Not allowed, and the screen feels like a trap.

D · Before You Cancel

Chosen

Their numbers, their worry, smaller moves

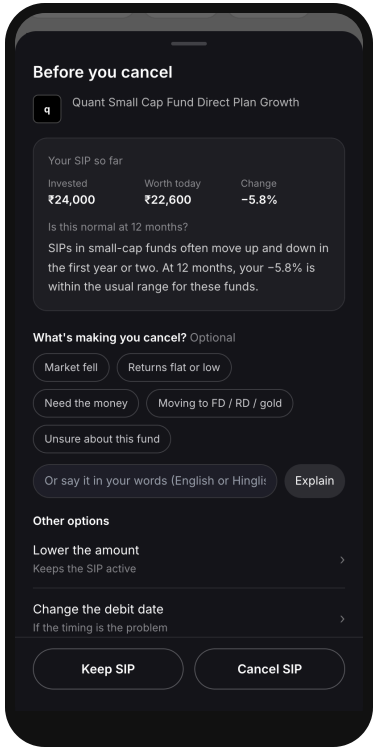
+ Hits the real gap: they can't tell what's normal

– The AI needs strict limits, so every reply is checked.

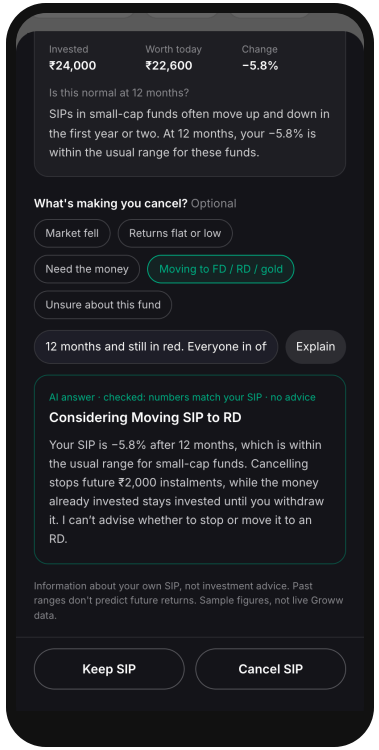
WHY IT NEEDS AI, NOT JUST BUTTONS

People rarely give one clean reason: "*market fell, dad says recession, should I pause?*" On 20 real posts, keyword rules picked the right answer **8** times; the AI **15–17**. Rules read "the Nippon India Gold fund is negative" as "moving my money to gold". The AI's only job is to read the worry and explain the user's own SIP. It can't add numbers, name funds, or say stop or continue.

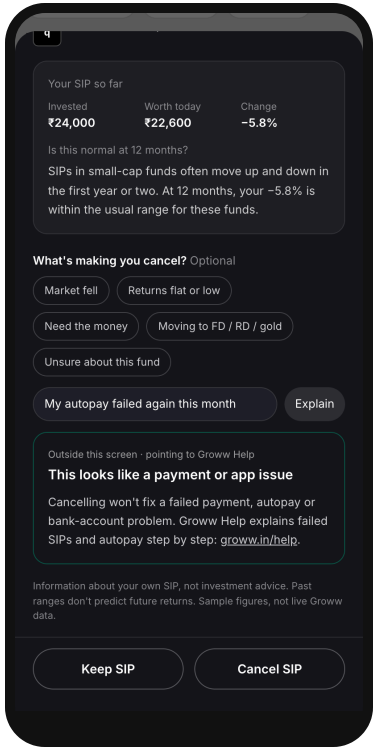
The sheet reads the worry in the user's own words and answers with their own numbers. Cancel stays one tap.



Tap to view full screen



Tap to view full screen



Tap to view full screen

Try it ↗

SIPs → Quant Small Cap → Cancel SIP → tap a reason or type a worry

CHECKED BEFORE IT'S SHOWN

Numbers must match the user's SIP. No fund names, no advice or fear words, 4 sentences max. If a check fails, a standard answer shows instead.

How I tested (3 runs)	Rules	AI
Understood the worry, 20 posts	8	**15–17**
Payment → Groww Help	1/10	**10/10**
Advice or fear shown	0	**0**

2 of 3 testers left with an SIP still running. Cancel was never blocked.

USER TESTING ON A REAL TASK

Task: "You're thinking of cancelling your SIP. Use the app to decide." Same people, own phone, thinking aloud.

	What they saw	Chose	Outcome
P1	Returns were red; the sheet helped them read the market	Hold	Kept the SIP
P4	Missed Skip on the first look	Cancel	Cancelled
P5	A lower price buys more units for the same money	Reduce	Halved the SIP; rest went elsewhere

What I changed: nothing yet. Next: put Skip higher, so P4 sees it before Cancel.

Metric	Why I chose it
North star	12-month active rate. It is Groww's goal.
Saved at cancel	Still active 30 days later — first sign the sheet worked.
Chose a smaller option	Reduce, skip or a new date. A smaller SIP still counts.
Still paying 90 days later	The save is real, not a cancel put off.

GUARDRAILS

- Time, taps and "can't cancel" complaints stay flat. Any rise and it rolls back.
- Ship an AI change only if: ≥14 of 20 posts understood, ≥8 of 10 payments sent to Help, 0 unsafe replies.

RISKS · LIMITATIONS

The real danger is a cancel screen that feels like a trap, or an AI line that sounds like advice

	Risk	What I'd do
1	**Feels like a retention trap**	Cancel sits on the first screen next to Keep SIP. Cancel time and complaints are guardrails with a rollback line.
2	**An AI reply reads like advice**	Check every reply, fall back to a standard answer, re-run the eval before any model or prompt change.
3	**"Usual range" read as a promise**	Build ranges from real category history published by the Association of Mutual Funds in India (AMFI), and keep "past ranges don't predict returns" on screen.
4	**It comes too late**	Next: ask for a goal and time frame at SIP start, then a month-6 "how am I doing" check-in.
5	**Payments still end SIPs**	Parallel operations fix: say why a debit failed, and prompt an autopay update after a bank change.

LIMITATIONS

5 interviews from my network, all at risk · public posts aren't Groww users · uplift rests on two assumptions (40% lapse, 30% recoverable) that cohort data would replace · golden set labelled by one person · eval run on MiniMax-M2.7, re-run on the live model before launch.